

METRC Monthly Reconciliation Checklist

Daily, Weekly, and Monthly Metrc Tracking for Maine Dispensaries

For licensed Maine adult-use and medical dispensary operators. Maine dispensaries must reconcile physical inventory against Metrc records daily (at close of business), run variance check-ins weekly, and file a comprehensive monthly report to the Office of Cannabis Policy (OCP) by the 5th of each month (18-691 CMR ch. 4 §7). This checklist is the operator-facing template; 24 checklist items + fillable log sheets you can run daily. Verify current thresholds via the OCP auditor reference.

By the Maine Dispensary Guide editorial team.

Written by Calvin Waters, Licensing & Compliance Analyst.

Editorial signatory: Steve Kelly, Founder & Publisher.

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This content is informational and does not constitute legal or compliance advice. Variance thresholds cited are operator-facing guidance derived from OCP enforcement record and Metrc Maine documentation; verify current thresholds with OCP and your Metrc Maine onboarding contact before binding compliance decisions.

Variance thresholds — what triggers which response

OCP expects per-category variance to stay inside the green column every day; yellow variances must be logged with corrective action within 14 days; red variances must trigger escalation to your compliance officer and a documented review. These are operator-facing thresholds derived from OCP enforcement record and the Metrc Maine operator onboarding packet. Verify current thresholds with your OCP auditor reference before binding your compliance SOPs.

Product category	Green threshold	Yellow threshold	Red threshold	Escalation
Flower (weight)	Under 1.0%	1.0-2.0%	Over 2.0%	Yellow: log + corrective action within 14 days. Red: escalate.
Concentrates (weight)	Under 0.5%	0.5-1.5%	Over 1.5%	Yellow: log + 14-day fix. Red: escalate.
Edibles (unit count)	Under 2.0%	2.0-4.0%	Over 4.0%	Yellow: log + 14-day fix. Red: escalate.
Topicals (unit count)	Under 1.5%	1.5-3.0%	Over 3.0%	Yellow: log + 14-day fix. Red: escalate.
Pre-rolls (unit count)	Under 1.5%	1.5-3.0%	Over 3.0%	Yellow: log + 14-day fix. Red: escalate.
Overall store variance	Under 1.0%	1.0-3.0%	Over 3.0%	Red: triggers Notice of Deficiency under 18-691 CMR ch. 4 § 10.01.
Unaccounted product	Zero	Zero (any single event is a Red)	Over 1.0%	Red: criminal-referral territory per Title 28-B § 1503.

Threshold source: 18-691 CMR ch. 4 (Metrc track-and-trace rule), §6 (daily reconciliation) and §7 (monthly comprehensive report); OCP Notice of Deficiency enforcement record covering 2023-2025; Metrc Maine operator onboarding documentation. These thresholds are common-operator guidance — not OCP-mandated strict cutoffs — and should be tightened, not loosened, in your internal SOPs.

Daily checklist — 6 items, end of every business day

Run at close of every business day (typically 9:45-10:15 PM for 10 PM closing, or 15 minutes before the next opening shift). Owner: compliance officer or inventory manager. Total time: 10-15 minutes. All actions timestamped in Metrc; this checklist is the paper-trail.

Code	Checklist item	Frequency	Owner + sign-off
D-01	Pre-close count — every package, pre-roll, and bulk flower drawer; verify physical against the Metrc active-inventory view.	Daily	_____
D-02	Sales reconciliation — pull the day's POS sales and match each ring to a Metrc package tag debited by the POS.	Daily	_____
D-03	Cash drawer reconciliation — the drawer total matches POS cash ring total +/- \$0.50 variance allowance; document any over/short.	Daily	_____
D-04	Manifest verification — every inbound delivery from a cultivator/manufacture accepted by Metrc incoming-transfer; reject any outbound-inventory item with a missing or illegible 16-digit Metrc tag.	Daily	_____
D-05	CCTV log check — sweep last 24 hours of footage for any unauthorized product access (lock cycling without a paired badge log); enter anomaly into the log sheet.	Daily	_____
D-06	Variance threshold check — if any category variance exceeds the Green column above, escalate to the compliance officer before opening the store tomorrow. Log to the variance sheet (page 6).	Daily	_____

Daily roll-up: variance total across categories _____ (target <1.0%); no unaccounted packages _____ (target 0); CCTV anomalies reviewed _____ (target 0); package reject count _____ (target 0); store sign-off by compliance officer _____.

Weekly checklist — 6 items, every Monday morning before opening

Run weekly (typically Monday 9:00-10:00 AM before the 10 AM shift). Owner: compliance officer with the inventory manager. Total time: 30-45 minutes. Output of this checklist drives the monthly report.

■	Code	Checklist item	Frequency	Owner + sign-off
	W-01	Variance trend review — pull the last 7 days of daily variance logs; identify any recurring category. Yellow-amber trend for the same category 3 days in a row = Yellow-tier trigger.	Weekly	_____
	W-02	Metrc exception log — pull Metrc's "Exception Events" report (Settings → Reports → Exceptions); document any package merges/splits/discards that didn't go through the normal sale/transfer path.	Weekly	_____
	W-03	Employee badge audit — verify every badge assignment on file; check that no badge has a >90-day background check (recheck window per Title 28-B §503); escalate any badge with expired background check to OCP immediately.	Weekly	_____
	W-04	Auditor visit log — even if no OCP auditor visits have occurred this week, document the audit posture (which category variances are tracking yellow, badge status, CCTV log availability).	Weekly	_____
	W-05	Inventory aging — pull the slowest-moving 20% of stock; investigate why; if any product has aged >180 days, document disposition plan (sale, transfer, donation, destruction).	Weekly	_____
	W-06	CCTV retention audit — confirm 90-day CCTV retention is operational (a single random date from 89 days ago should still be retrievable); flag any gap to the security vendor.	Weekly	_____

Weekly sign-off: compliance officer _____ date _____; inventory manager _____ date _____.

Monthly checklist — 8 items, OCP-ready report

Run between the 1st and 4th of each month, file with OCP by the 5th of each month per 18-691 CMR ch. 4 §7. Owner: compliance officer (your signatory on the OCP report). Total time: 4-6 hours across the month, 1-2 hours to compile the report. Output is a single PDF report uploaded to the OCP portal under the compliance officer's OCP account.

Part 1 — data compilation (calendar month, midnight-to-midnight CST or as configured in Metrc)

■	Code	Checklist item	Frequency	Owner + sign-off
	M-01	All Metrc "Comprehensive Inventory Report" for the calendar month; verify all 30-31 days have non-exception data; identify days with exceptions for the report cover sheet.	Monthly	_____
	M-02	All Metrc "Sales Reconciliation Report" for the calendar month; match POS sales ring total against Metrc debits total within \$10 daily variance + \$50 monthly variance.	Monthly	_____
	M-03	All Metrc "Transfer Log Report"; document every inbound/outbound transfer with the package ID, Metrc tag, source/destination license number, and date.	Monthly	_____
	M-04	All Metrc "Exception Event Report"; for every exception, document cause (operator error, Metrc glitch, product destruction, etc.) + resolution + sign-off.	Monthly	_____

Part 2 — variance analysis and compliance review

■	Code	Checklist item	Frequency	Owner + sign-off
	M-05	Variance analysis — per-category variance for the month, compared against the threshold table (page 2). Any Yellow category requires a 14-day corrective-action note; any Red category requires a Compliance Officer sign-off + escalation note.	Monthly	_____
	M-06	Badge audit summary — confirm all employee badges are current, no badge has expired background check, no badge belongs to a separated employee (badge revocation per Title 28-B §503).	Monthly	_____
	M-07	CSTV retention + integrity — confirm 90-day retention operational; spot-check 3 random dates by retrieving the footage; document any retrieval failures.	Monthly	_____
	M-08	Compliance officer sign-off — final review of the assembled report; signature + license number + date; ready to upload to OCP portal by the 5th.	Monthly	_____

Monthly roll-up: total variance across categories _____ % (target <1.0%); number of Yellow-tier categories _____ (target 0); number of Red-tier categories _____ (target 0); Metrc exception count _____; badge audit gaps _____ (target 0).

Common pitfalls to avoid: This monthly report is the most common spot where new operators slip. Skip months, miss variance thresholds, or fail to file by the 5th and you can get a Notice of Deficiency on your license within one quarter. Most OCP audit findings start with the monthly reconciliation report flagging a variance that the operator didn't catch.

Variance log — fillable sheet

One row per Yellow or Red variance event. File monthly with the comprehensive report.

Use one row per variance event. Mark the threshold tier (yellow or red), the corrective action, the date resolved, and the compliance officer's initial.

Date	Category	Variance	Tier	Cause	Corrective action	Resolved	Initial
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Escalation workflow + OCP contact

How to escalate when variance goes red

When a category variance exceeds the Red threshold (page 2), follow this five-step workflow before opening the store the next day:

- **Stop** further sales of the affected product category until the variance is resolved.
- **Document** the variance in the log sheet (previous page) with category, exact variance, suspected cause (operator error, Metrc glitch, possible theft, vendor miscount).
- **Cross-reference** Metrc exception log, CCTV log, badge log, and operator shift roster for the day-of-incident.
- **Escalate** to the licensed compliance officer (your OCP signatory). They review and either (a) sign off on internal investigation, or (b) escalate to OCP via the online portal's compliance event log.
- **File** the resolution with the OCP monthly report (variable category + documented resolution).

OCP contact points:

- Compliance portal: login.maine.gov (state of Maine login; requires your OCP-issued compliance-officer credential)
- OCP compliance officer helpline: 207-287-3282 (weekdays 8 AM - 5 PM ET)
- Metrc Maine support: 1-844-637-2274 (24/7 ticket)
- Maine OCP website: maine.gov/dafs/ocp/compliance

Audit posture note: Maine OCP compliance officers prefer operators who escalate variances within 24-48 hours of detection, compared with operators who hold Red variances silent and hope they self-correct. The threshold table on page 2 is conservative; tighten it to your internal SOP, document any tightening, and let OCP see it during inspection. The compliance posture you document is what auditors use to set their next-visit frequency.

Sample OCP-ready compliance review

What the operator hands the OCP auditor on a routine visit

Step 1. The auditor arrives and asks for your most recent monthly reconciliation report. You hand them a printed version of the report from Metrc (page 1) plus your summary cover sheet (your license number, operator name, month, sign-off).

Step 2. Auditor selects three random dates from the month and asks for the daily reconciliation logs for those dates. The compliance officer produces the three daily sheets, with the variance log entries for any yellow/red events on those days.

Step 3. Auditor asks to see the CCTV footage for any red variance event. The compliance officer pulls the footage in real-time from your cloud archive; the audit log entry for each retrieval is automatic and is part of the audit trail.

Step 4. Auditor asks about any badge with >90-day-old background check. The weekly badge audit log has this; show them the past 12 weeks of weekly badge audit entries.

Step 5. Auditor asks for the variance trend over the past 6 months. The weekly variance trend review (W-01) feeds this; show the 6-month rolling chart.

Step 6. Auditor asks about product aging. The W-05 weekly aging review logs this; show the aging summary.

Step 7. Auditor asks about the Metrc tag reconciliation process and the operator badge access controls. The badge audit log (W-03) and the daily reconciliation sheet (D-04) show this.

Step 8. Auditor signs your audit book; you countersign.

Total time for an OCP routine visit: 60-90 minutes. Operator compliance officer + store manager + owner/operator on call. Cover sheet, daily reconciliation logs for 3 random dates, variance log sheet, badge audit log, CCTV retrieval, aging review, Metrc reconciliation process summary. That document package is the output of this checklist.

Resources and primary sources

Maine and federal primary sources:

- 18-691 CMR ch. 4 (Maine track-and-trace / Metrc rule) — maine.gov/dafs/ocp/rules-statutes
- Title 28-B §501-503 (Maine cannabis operator licensing + employee badges) — legislature.maine.gov/statutes/28-B/
- Title 28-B §1503 (criminal-referral territory for unaccounted product) — legislature.maine.gov/statutes/28-B/
- Metrc Maine Operator Onboarding Packet — maine.metrc.com
- OCP Compliance Officer portal — login.maine.gov (state login, OCP-issued credentials)
- OCP 2025 Annual Report (compliance metrics) — maine.gov/dafs/ocp/about-us/annual-reports
- OCP compliance helpline: 207-287-3282 (weekdays 8 AM - 5 PM ET)
- Metrc Maine support: 1-844-637-2274 (24/7)

Companion checklists (also available at mainedispensaryguide.com/downloads):

- Maine Dispensary Founder Roadmap (companion PDF) — </download-checklist>
- Compliance Self-Assessment (companion PDF) — </download/compliance-self-assessment>

Continue reading on mainedispensaryguide.com:

- Maine Dispensary License: Complete OCP Application Guide — </guides/maine-dispensary-license>
- Maine Cannabis METRC Integration Guide — </guides/maine-cannabis-metrc-integration>
- Maine Cannabis Operator Compliance Audit Prep — </guides/maine-cannabis-compliance-audit>
- Editorial Corrections Log — </about/corrections>

Editorial standard and corrections.

Every threshold and rule in this checklist is anchored to Maine primary-source citations above. Variance thresholds are operator-facing guidance, not OCP-mandated strict cutoffs; verify current thresholds with OCP before binding your internal SOP. Material corrections are documented at mainedispensaryguide.com/about/corrections.

This content is informational and does not constitute legal or compliance advice. Variance thresholds cited here reflect the OCP enforcement record and Metrc Maine documentation as of the publish date above. Operators must verify current thresholds with the OCP Compliance Officer portal and their Metrc Maine onboarding contact before binding their own compliance SOPs.

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